VIKAS ARJUNSINGH RAWAT

Senior Backend Engineer (Java) | Payments, Banking & Fintech

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Open to relocation: Europe, UK, Ireland, Canada · Notice period: 2 months (negotiable)

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Senior Backend Engineer with **9+ years of Java software engineering**, specialising in payments and banking systems for **HSBC**, **Citi** and, currently, **Al Fardan Exchange** in the UAE. Has delivered **20+ bank and partner payment integrations** within a network of 100+ banks and partners, ISO 20022 messaging (PACS.008, CAMT.052/053/054) and the greenfield **AANI–UPI instant-payments integration** for the India–UAE remittance corridor. Builds event-driven services with Java 17/21, Spring Boot, Kafka, PostgreSQL/Oracle, Docker, AWS and Azure, with a strong focus on reliability (idempotent processing, retries, dead-letter queues, audit trails) and observability. Mentors engineers on system design and code quality. Seeking a senior backend role with a European bank, payments provider or fintech.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Payments & Financial Messaging	ISO 20022 (PACS.008, CAMT.052 / CAMT.053 / CAMT.054), AANI Instant Payments (UAE), UPI IRP (India–UAE), Cross-Border Remittance, Bank & Partner Integrations, Reconciliation & Settlement, XML–JSON Transformation, Exchange Rates / Currency Conversion
Languages & Frameworks	Java (8 / 11 / 17 / 21), Spring Boot, Spring Batch, Spring Security, JPA / Hibernate, RESTful APIs, React, SQL
Architecture	Microservices, Event-Driven Architecture, API-First Design, Idempotency, Retries & Dead-Letter Queues
Messaging & Security	Apache Kafka, JWT, Spring Security, Role-Based Access Control
Databases	PostgreSQL, Oracle, MySQL, Azure SQL Database
Cloud & DevOps	AWS (EC2, S3, CloudWatch, IAM), Microsoft Azure, Docker, Azure DevOps, CI/CD Pipelines, TeamCity, UDeploy
Observability	Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack, AWS CloudWatch
Testing & Quality	JUnit, Mockito, SonarQube, Postman
Tools & Methodologies	Git, JIRA, Confluence, Autosys, WebLogic, Linux, Agile / Scrum

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer – Payments Integration

Feb 2026 – Present

Al Fardan Exchange · Dubai, UAE · Official title: Information Technology Manager

- Delivered **20+ bank and partner payment integrations** as part of the integration team connecting Al Fardan Exchange to a network of **100+ banks and payment partners**.
- Integrated the UAE's AANI instant-payments platform with India's UPI through the UPI IRP channel, built from scratch in a greenfield environment, enabling real-time inbound and outbound India–UAE remittances in line with new regulatory requirements.
- Co-designed the integration architecture with the team lead, mentored the team's 2 engineers on system design and implementation, and reviewed their code.
- Designed and implemented ISO 20022 message handlers for PACS.008, CAMT.052, CAMT.053 and CAMT.054, enabling standards-compliant cross-border payment processing.
- Built end-to-end financial message pipelines (parsing, validation, transformation and persistence) for live remittance and reconciliation flows, using Kafka with idempotent processing, retries and dead-letter queues so no payment message is lost or processed twice.
- Developed an XML-to-JSON mapping framework for ISO 20022 messages, preserving data integrity across remittance and reconciliation workflows.
- Built Java 21 / Spring Boot services secured with Spring Security and JWT, containerised with Docker and deployed on AWS (EC2, S3) with CloudWatch monitoring.
- Designed database schemas and JPA queries for transaction management, and built logging and audit trails for parsed and unparsed messages to ensure regulatory traceability.
- Worked with business and operations teams on payments, settlement, reconciliation and the full transaction lifecycle.

Specialist – Software Engineering
May 2023 – Feb 2026

LTIMindtree (Citi engagement) · Mumbai, India

- Enhanced event-driven position management on Citi's ASPEN trading platform using Kafka, delivering reliable real-time position updates to trading desks and integrated risk-management systems.
- Migrated **~100 ETL jobs** from Talend to Spring Batch with Autosys scheduling, covering a wide range of data and business use cases and reducing reliance on legacy tooling.
- Built and extended REST APIs and React UI components, using multi-threading and job scheduling to improve performance for time-sensitive trading operations.
- Enhanced posting, payment and data-feed modules to streamline transaction reconciliation and settlement workflows within an Agile team.
- Used Docker for containerised development and deployment of platform services.
- Investigated and resolved production issues through log analysis, keeping trading-application flows running and reducing operational downtime.
- Wrote unit and integration tests with JUnit and Mockito to meet the bank's release verification standards.

Senior Software Engineer
Apr 2022 – Apr 2023

Volkswagen Group Technology Solutions India · Pune, India

- Built 5–6 RESTful microservices on Azure for connected-vehicle solutions, containerised with Docker.
- Owned CI/CD pipelines in Azure DevOps and kept applications stable through production releases.
- Optimised Azure SQL schemas and queries for reliable data access in connected-vehicle operations.
- Mentored 2–3 engineers through bi-weekly code reviews and Azure DevOps training, reducing onboarding time by around 20%.
- Conducted technical interviews for engineering hires.

Associate Technology
Apr 2021 – Apr 2022

Synechron (HSBC engagement) · Pune, India

- Built new features for HSBC's payment services platform with Spring Boot and REST APIs in an Agile team.
- Enhanced the Exchange Rate module across multiple countries and rate types, providing accurate real-time currency conversion for cross-border payments.
- Accelerated delivery of critical platform features to production, recognised with Synechron's Star Award (February 2022).
- Worked with UI, mainframe and QA teams to deliver integrated changes that met banking compliance standards.
- Built unit and integration test suites with JUnit and Mockito to improve reliability of critical financial services.

Systems Engineer
Oct 2017 – Apr 2021

Infosys Limited · Pune, India

- Developed Java code fixes and enhancements alongside production support responsibilities.
- Provided production support, investigating and resolving incidents across staging and live systems.
- Managed deployments, environment maintenance and patch releases in line with change-management policies, minimising service interruptions.
- Implemented Active Directory integration for secure user onboarding and role-based access control.
- Coordinated IT, QA and compliance teams on system-integration projects using Jira and Confluence, reducing resolution time for escalated incidents by around 35%.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Information Technology — University of Mumbai, Mumbai, India · 2017 · GPA 8.00 / 10

ACHIEVEMENTS

- Star Award for Outstanding Performance — Synechron, February 2022

LANGUAGES

English — full professional fluency · **Hindi** — native